BARBELL BACK SQUAT

ATTENTION: For the barbell back squat, since the exercise is quite technical, it is recommended that you ***watch the full exercise tutorial video***. If needed, perform the exercise regression included in the video first if needed before performing the full barbell back squat.

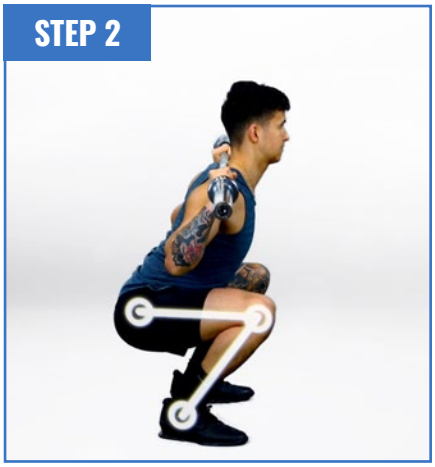
STEP 1: SETUP

Set a barbell in a rack at about the height of your mid-chest. Face the bar and grip it with your hands slightly wider than shoulder-width apart. Duck under the bar and place it over the back of your shoulders, letting it rest on your upper traps. Lift it out of the rack by extending your legs. Take one step back with one foot, one step back with the other one, and then use a third step to correct your stance into an even position. The optimal foot stance will vary, but first experiment with a stance that is just outside shoulder-width with your toes pointed outwards at about 15 degree angle.

STEP 2

Plant your feet firmly into the ground, pull the bar down into your upper back, and engage your core. Take a deep breath in through your nose, and then squat straight down by bending at your hips and knees. As you do so, the bar should remain over the level of your midfoot and the weight should be evenly distributed between your big toe, your little toe, and your heels. Your knees should also be bending slightly outwards in the same direction of your toes. Continue squatting down until your thighs reach at least parallel or slightly below. From here, while keeping your core engaged, exhale and reverse the movement by extending your legs, thinking about bringing the bar up towards the ceiling and exhaling as you do so.

When done correctly, the bar should make an almost perfectly vertical path down and up each rep. Depending on your anatomy, your torso may end up more vertical or more bent over than others, which is normal as long as you're following the tips and avoiding the common mistakes.



ADDITIONAL TIPS: If you find it difficult to reach full depth, you can try elevating your heels onto weight plates to help with ankle mobility.